

The supreme law of the house

19 Larkspur Terrace Declaration of Independence Constitution

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Part I

Preamble

We, the housemates of 19 Larkspur Terrace, in order to form a more perfect household, establish justice, ensure domestic tranquillity, and promote the general welfare of all who dwell within, do hereby ordain and establish this Constitution as the supreme law of the house. All persons residing within, visiting, or otherwise subject to the jurisdiction of 19 Larkspur Terrace shall be bound by its provisions.

Membership & Visitors

Article 1 — Housemates

- 1.1 The five permanent housemates of 19 Larkspur Terrace are: George Cronin, George Bale, Alexander Pear, Freddie Austin Smith, and Oliver Shawyer.
- 1.2 Membership is fixed for the duration of this Constitution. There shall be no new housemates and no departing housemates during the constitutional period.
- 1.3 All housemates are subject to the full provisions of this Constitution at all times whilst within the house and its jurisdictional spaces.

Article 2 — Visitors

- 2.1 Any non-member wishing to enter 19 Larkspur Terrace must be signed in by means of a standard Visitor Pass upon entry.
- 2.2 Visitors are fully subject to the law of this Constitution whilst on the premises and may be prosecuted for offences committed therein.
- 2.3 Visitors are entitled to a Temporary Cutlery Pass upon entry, granting twenty (20) minutes of cutlery usage.
- 2.4 **Sponsor liability:** the housemate who signs in a visitor stands surety for them. If a visitor is convicted and does not return to serve their sentence within one (1) week of the verdict, the sponsoring housemate serves the full punishment in their place.

Article 3 — Executive Visitor Pass (EVP)

- 3.1 The EVP is an elevated visitor status granting additional rights within the house, including participation in committee member elections.

- 3.2** To qualify, a visitor must satisfy all of the following:
- (a) Visit the house consistently at a minimum of twice per week;
 - (b) Attend at least one social outing with the house per week;
and
 - (c) Be known and accepted by every housemate for a minimum of one month.
- 3.3** Qualification is verified by the Committee Committee, then ratified by tribunal vote of the housemates only.
- 3.4** Maximum five (5) EVP holders at any one time. EVP may be revoked by prosecution and tribunal vote of housemates only — no external jury members permitted for revocation proceedings.
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Part III

The Committee System

Article 4 — General Committee Provisions

- 4.1** All committees, unless otherwise specified, shall consist of two (2) members.
- 4.2** All housemates are default candidates for every committee, elected by ranked choice voting of the full house, including a candidate voting on their own race. EVP holders may also vote in committee elections.
- 4.3** A housemate may sit on as many committees as they are elected to, without restriction. Each housemate may abstain from candidacy for one (1) committee of their choosing.
- 4.4** Every committee holds elections once per month, except the Committee Committee, which follows its own staggered cycle under 5.2, and the Inter-Room Committee (Article 10), which is ad-hoc and holds none.

- 4.5** Every committee must maintain a minimum of one (1) member at all times. If membership would otherwise fall to zero, an election to fill the vacancy is held immediately.

Article 5 — The Committee Committee

- 5.1** Manages the voting process of all other committees and oversees all committee elections.
- 5.2** Operates on a staggered election cycle of once every two months, convening one week before the monthly committee elections.
- 5.3** If prosecuted for mismanagement or rigging of an election, the prosecution shall be brought by the Rules Committee. Conversely, if the Rules Committee is prosecuted, the Committee Committee brings that prosecution. Each serves as the other's check and balance.
- 5.4** Any dispute between the Rules Committee and the Committee Committee that does not amount to a prosecution under 5.3 shall be resolved by tribunal vote of the full house.
- 5.5** Notwithstanding 5.1, elections for the Committee Committee itself are administered by the Rules Committee.

Article 6 — The Rules Committee

- 6.1** Holds exclusive authority to propose amendments to this Constitution, per the procedure set out in Part VII.
- 6.2** Any individual member of the Rules Committee may be impeached by a **unanimous** vote of every housemate and EVP holder who is not a member of the Rules Committee. Impeachment removes only the named member — where the Rules Committee has more than one member, each must be impeached separately. Upon impeachment, the vacated seat is filled by immediate election.

Article 7 — The Pass Committee

- 7.1** Oversees all temporary passes, ensuring they are stocked and correctly placed at their designated locations:

Pass type	Location
Temporary Bathroom Pass (2nd floor)	Back of the 2nd floor bathroom door
Temporary Bathroom Pass (1st floor)	Back of the 1st floor bathroom door
Temporary Crockery Pass	Kitchen cupboard or near the fridge
Temporary Cutlery Pass	Near the cutlery drawer

Article 8 — The Location Committee

- 8.1** Either party to a matter under this Constitution may refer a dispute over a person's location, whereabouts, or presence within the house to the Location Committee for a ruling — including the validity of a service attempt under Article 19, and whether a grace-period timer was correctly paused or resumed under 12.2.
- 8.2** Its rulings are not final; either party may escalate to a jury trial under 20.1–20.3.

Article 9 — Room-Based Committees

Committee	Jurisdiction	Size
Kitchen Committee	Kitchen	2
Living Room Committee	Living Room	2
Corridor Committee	Corridor	2
Stairs Committee	Stairs	2

Committee	Jurisdiction	Size
Bathroom Committee (1st floor)	Alexander Pear, Freddie Austin Smith, Oliver Shawyer	3
Bathroom Committee (2nd floor)	George Cronin, George Bale	2
Bedroom Committee	All Bedrooms	2

Article 10 — The Inter-Room Committee

- 10.1** A temporary, ad-hoc body convened whenever an offence may implicate more than one committee's jurisdiction. The prosecuting party nominates the committees they believe are implicated, provisionally seeding the Inter-Room Committee with one representative from each.
- 10.2** By simple majority of its provisional members, the Inter-Room Committee decides which councils must be represented for the offence, adding representatives from any further committee found to hold jurisdiction.
- 10.3** Once composition is settled, one (1) representative sits per committee so determined, regardless of that committee's size, selected by that committee itself. A member sitting on more than one relevant committee is automatically selected for all. Disbands upon resolution.

Part IV

Room Legislation

Article 11 — The Kitchen

- 11.1** Disturbance to the status quo is determined by the *reasonable person test* — whether a reasonable person would consider the kitchen to have been left in an unacceptable state.

- 11.2** Upon a disturbance being identified, a twelve (12) hour grace period commences. If unresolved, a Kitchen Committee member may commence prosecution.
- 11.3 Crockery Pass:** any housemate using another's crockery must complete and obtain the owner's signature on a Temporary Crockery Pass. No limit on passes per week.
- 11.4 Cutlery Pass:** all visitors must obtain a Temporary Cutlery Pass (no counter-signature required), granting twenty (20) minutes of cutlery usage including wash-up. Exceeding the window results in forcible removal of cutlery. A visitor may obtain as many Temporary Cutlery Passes in a single visit as they like, provided no two passes are active at the same time.

Article 12 — The Living Room

- 12.1** Disturbance to the status quo determined case by case, with reference to the understood status quo at the time of the offence and by decision of the prosecution.
- 12.2** A six (6) hour grace period commences, counted on time spent within the house. If the offending individual leaves, the timer stops and restarts on return.

Article 13 — The Bathrooms

- 13.1** The two bathrooms are entirely independently governed by their respective owners and committees.
- 13.2 1st floor bathroom:** Alexander Pear, Freddie Austin Smith, Oliver Shawyer. **2nd floor bathroom:** George Cronin, George Bale.
- 13.3 Bathroom Pass:** cross-floor use requires a signed Temporary Bathroom Pass (countersigned by a floor owner). Maximum three (3) usages per week. Unauthorised or secret use is prosecutable. Forgetting a pass provides no legal defence.
- 13.4** A bathroom owner may refuse to sign a pass with a valid reason. Validity is determined by the reasonable person test; if disputed,

by tribunal. The refused party may prosecute on the basis of damages caused by the refusal.

Article 14 — The Bedrooms

- 14.1** All five bedrooms operate under identical legislation. Loud noise is prohibited between **11:00 pm and 7:00 am**. During curfew hours, noise must be kept to a minimum.
- 14.2** Whether a bedroom door is open or closed during curfew is entirely at the occupant's discretion; they accept full responsibility for any resulting noise.
- 14.3** Odours affecting the surrounding corridor are a cross-jurisdictional offence between the Bedroom Committee and the Corridor Committee, and trigger the Inter-Room Committee.
- 14.4** Bedroom items causing clutter in communal spaces constitute a low-level offence of common area spillover, attracting a correspondingly low sentencing tier.

Article 15 — The Corridor & Stairs

- 15.1** The Corridor Committee and Stairs Committee hold jurisdiction over their respective spaces. Offences spanning both spaces trigger the Inter-Room Committee.

Article 16 — The Punishment Room

- 16.1** The Punishment Room is the formal sentencing facility of the house. Its sentencing tiers:

Tier	Duration	Conditions
Tier 1	5 minutes	Standard
Tier 2	10 minutes	Standard
Tier 3	5 minutes	No phone

Tier	Duration	Conditions
Tier 4	10 minutes	No phone
Tier 5	20 minutes	No phone
Tier 6	20 minutes	No phone, no light
Tier 7	15 minutes	No phone, no light, controlled speaker

16.2 The prosecution determines the tier applied. Additional punishments beyond the Punishment Room tiers may also be imposed. The jury may vote to reduce the proposed punishment; this process is iterative until the jury is satisfied.

16.3 Refusal to enter the Punishment Room without a valid reason or without invoking Article I of the Bill of Rights is an aggravating factor leading to sentence increase.

16.4 The selection of any Punishment Room tier or Cleaning Punishment tier must have regard to the Sentencing Guidelines in Schedule B. A prosecution departing from the guideline band must state its reasons; an unexplained departure is a mitigating factor the jury must weigh in the defendant's favour.

Article 17 — Cleaning Punishments

17.1 The Cleaning Punishment is a formal sentencing mechanism, available as a standalone punishment or stacked on top of a Punishment Room tier:

Tier	Room	Required tasks
Cleaning Tier 1	Corridor	Hoover the corridor
Cleaning Tier 2	Stairs	Hoover the stairs

Tier	Room	Required tasks
Cleaning Tier 3	Living Room	Hoover the living room; mop the floor
Cleaning Tier 4	Kitchen	Hoover; mop floor; wipe all surfaces; clean hob; clean inside microwave
Cleaning Tier 5	Both Bathrooms	Clean toilet; clean sink; mop floor; wipe all surfaces — both bathrooms
Cleaning Tier 6	Full House	All of the above in full

- 17.2** One cleaning tier maximum per underlying offence. Where a single prosecution charges multiple separate offences together, each offence may draw its own cleaning tier.
- 17.3** Cleaning Tier 6 may be split across multiple days with a one (1) week time limit. All other tiers must be completed in a single sitting.
- 17.4** The jury retains the right to vote for reduction of any cleaning punishment.

Part V

Prosecution & Tribunal

Article 18 — Right to Prosecute

- 18.1** The following may bring a prosecution: any housemate; any EVP holder.
- 18.2** The following may be prosecuted: any housemate; any EVP holder; any visitor.

Article 19 — Service of Papers

- 19.1** A prosecution is formally commenced by serving papers upon the defendant, which must display in large writing:

YOU'VE BEEN SERVED

- 19.2** Service formally opens the prosecution and triggers the right of both parties to begin preparing their case.
- 19.3** Service must be completed within **three (3) days** of the offence. If the defendant cannot reasonably be located, a reasonable attempt to deliver the papers (e.g., leaving them at the defendant's known location) constitutes valid service. Whether an attempt was reasonable is determined by the Location Committee (Article 8), appealable to a jury trial under 20.1–20.3.

Article 20 — The Tribunal

- 20.1** All proceedings are entirely self-organised. The prosecution and defendant each present their own case to the jury. The defendant may represent themselves litigant in person.
- 20.2** Jury consists of one (1) to five (5) persons, drawn only from housemates and EVP holders who are neither the prosecution nor the defendant in the matter. Simple majority verdict required. In the event of a tied vote, a sibling of a housemate — present and not connected to either party — casts the deciding vote, which is final.
- 20.3** Both parties have the right to call witnesses. Witnesses cannot be compelled to appear. A prosecution brought in bad faith is itself a prosecutable offence.
- 20.4** Wherever this Constitution calls for a tribunal vote of the full house (including under Article 5, Part VII, and Article 22 appeals), every housemate and EVP holder who is not the defendant in the matter is entitled to vote, and a simple majority — over half of eligible voters — is required to pass, except where this Constitution specifies otherwise (e.g., the unanimous vote required to impeach a Rules Committee member under 6.2, and the housemates-only vote on EVP status under Article 3).

Article 21 — Statute of Limitations

- 21.1** Any offence for which service of papers (Article 19) is not completed within **three (3) days** of its commission is null and void.

Article 22 — Appeals

- 22.1** Any party to a non-unanimous tribunal verdict may appeal, within **forty-eight (48) hours** of the verdict, by demanding a new hearing, provided they present evidence not considered at the original tribunal. A unanimous verdict may not be appealed.
- 22.2** The appeal hearing follows the standard tribunal process of Article 20, convened with a newly assembled jury, and must take place within **seventy-two (72) hours** of the appeal being demanded.
- 22.3** Only one appeal is permitted per offence. The verdict of the appeal hearing is final, regardless of unanimity.
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Part VI

The Bill of Rights

Article I — The right of postponement

Any punishment may be postponed for up to one (1) week upon utterance of the command phrase: ***"Stop it, I do not like this anymore!"***

Invocable once per offence only, independently for each separate offence. The defendant remains fully convicted during the postponement week and may serve their sentence at any point during it. The right to appeal is preserved.

Article II — The right to a timely tribunal

Every defendant has the right to a fair and timely tribunal. A prosecution may not be indefinitely delayed once formally filed. The statute of limitations in Article 21 governs timeliness.

Article III — The right against double jeopardy

No housemate, EVP holder, or visitor may be prosecuted twice for the same offence. Once a verdict is delivered, the matter is permanently closed, save for a single appeal under Article 22.

Article IV — The right to call witnesses

Both the prosecution and the defendant have the right to call witnesses during tribunal proceedings. Witnesses may not be compelled to appear and retain the right to refuse.

Article V — The right to bedroom privacy

Every housemate has the right to privacy within their own bedroom. No housemate may enter another's bedroom without the explicit permission of the occupant.

Article VI — The presumption of innocence

Every defendant is presumed innocent until found guilty by tribunal vote. The burden of proof lies with the prosecution.

Part VII

Constitutional Amendments

- 1 New rules and amendments may only be proposed by the Rules Committee.

- 2 All proposed amendments must be ratified by a tribunal vote of the house before taking effect.
 - 3 No amendment may remove or diminish the rights enshrined in the Bill of Rights.
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Part VIII

External Relations & Emergency Provisions

Article 23 — The Foreign Affairs Committee & Treaties

- 23.1 The Foreign Affairs Committee holds exclusive authority to negotiate treaties with other households, including noise pacts, mutual aid agreements, item-lending conventions, and reciprocal EVP recognition.
- 23.2 No treaty binds the house until ratified by a tribunal vote of the full house under 20.4.
- 23.3 Ratified treaties rank below this Constitution. Any treaty term conflicting with this Constitution or the Bill of Rights is void to the extent of the conflict.
- 23.4 The house may withdraw from a treaty by the same vote required to ratify it. Withdrawal must be notified in writing to the counterpart household.

Article 24 — States of Emergency

- 24.1 Any housemate may declare a State of Emergency upon the arrival, or confirmed imminent arrival, of an external authority — including a landlord or agent inspection, a parental visit, or tradespeople.

- 24.2** During a State of Emergency: all pass requirements are suspended; all grace-period timers are paused; and no new prosecution may be commenced in respect of conduct forming part of the emergency response.
- 24.3** The State of Emergency ends automatically when the external party departs the premises. Any time limit (service, appeal, grace period) suspended during the emergency resumes upon its end.
- 24.4** A declaration made in bad faith — where no external party arrives or was genuinely expected — is a prosecutable offence falling within Band 3 (Serious) of Schedule B.

Schedule A

Full Committee Directory

Committee	Size	Election cycle	Oversight
Kitchen Committee	2	Monthly	Inter-Room if cross-jurisdictional
Living Room Committee	2	Monthly	Inter-Room if cross-jurisdictional
Corridor Committee	2	Monthly	Inter-Room if cross-jurisdictional
Stairs Committee	2	Monthly	Inter-Room if cross-jurisdictional
Bathroom Committee (1st floor)	3	Monthly	Independent

Committee	Size	Election cycle	Oversight
Bathroom Committee (2nd floor)	2	Monthly	Independent
Bedroom Committee	2	Monthly	Inter-Room if cross-jurisdictional
Rules Committee	2	Monthly	Prosecuted by Committee Committee; members individually impeachable by unanimous vote of the rest of the house
Committee Committee	2	Bi-monthly (staggered)	Prosecuted by Rules Committee; elections run by Rules Committee
Pass Committee	2	Monthly	Standard
Location Committee	2	Monthly	Rulings appealable to tribunal
Foreign Affairs Committee	2	Monthly	Treaties require full-house ratification (23.2)
Inter-Room Committee	1 per committee	Ad-hoc	Temporary

Schedule B

Sentencing Guidelines

These guidelines are binding under clause 16.4. The prosecution selects a tier within the band for the offence; departures require stated reasons.

Band	Range	Example offences
Band 1 — Minor	Punishment Room Tiers 1–2	Common area spillover (14.4); a kitchen disturbance remedied shortly after the grace period; a visitor's cutlery overrun under ten minutes
Band 2 — Moderate	Tiers 3–4, plus Cleaning Tiers 1–2	Kitchen disturbance unresolved past the grace period (11.2); curfew noise (14.1); living room status quo disturbance (12.1); an odour offence (14.3)
Band 3 — Serious	Tiers 5–6, plus Cleaning Tiers 3–4	Unauthorised or secret bathroom use (13.3); forging or falsifying a pass; a bad-faith emergency declaration (24.4); a second Band 2 offence within one month
Band 4 — Egregious	Tier 7, plus Cleaning Tiers 5–6	A prosecution brought in bad faith (20.3); violation of bedroom privacy (Bill of Rights V); tampering with a committee election (5.3); a second Band 3 offence within one month

Aggravating factors

- Refusing to enter the Punishment Room without valid reason (16.3)
- Committing the offence during a declared State of Emergency
- Concealing evidence or lying to the tribunal
- Targeting a visitor who cannot easily defend themselves

Mitigating factors

- Remedying the disturbance before prosecution commenced

- A first offence
 - Self-reporting the offence
 - A genuine apology accepted by the affected party
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Ratification

We, the undersigned housemates of 19 Larkspur Terrace, do hereby adopt and ratify this Constitution as the supreme law of the house.

George Cronin

George Bale

Alexander Pear

Freddie Austin Smith

Oliver Sawyer

Date of ratification